

TIRRA General Meeting

Thursday, October 6th, 2022, 7:00PM

President Wendy Hinsperger called the meeting to order at 7:00 PM with the following also present:

- Vice President, Quentin Goodbody
- Treasurer and Solid Waste Chairperson, Ernie Hunter
- Secretary, Lisa Vernon
- St. Margaret's Cemetery Chairperson, Suzanne Sarioglu
- Transportation Chairperson, Stu Downey
- Trails Chairperson, Vicki Walker
- Espokes Chairperson, Claire Hess
- 31 individuals in attendance which includes the board

Wendy Hinsperger welcomed everyone and noted that the meeting will be recorded at the Podium: All are asked to speak from the podium/microphone as a courtesy to all attendees.

The Minutes of the TIRRA Annual General Meeting on July 23rd, 2022: adopted as found online.

MOTION: Veronica Shelford, seconded by Keith Rush, and approved by all members.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

President's Report: Posted online. Wendy thanked the TIRRA Executive for the extra time put in on the difficult work since July. Refer meeting minutes as posted on TIRRA Office page. Many meetings and a lot of perseverance to document the necessary steps to resolve issues. It is a process not a single action, including bylaw changes and new territory for TIRRA requiring significant changes in notification methods. Thank you to Veronica Shelford for her exemplary support in the contact of members and database corrections: as well as Marjan Jackman for her technical guidance (experience from TICA notification process).

Trails Report: Posted online. Vicki wished to thank all who came out to help with the Lawrence Valley Loop. Vicki co-ordinates the Trails Committee but would like to have a Co-Chair, not elected, just a Rep, mostly to assist with meetings and correspondence with TIRRA Exec.

Cemetery Report: No report posted. Suzanne thanked Wendy for her vast amount of work during this time. Said all is quiet but Dave Reay was working on something that is yet to be released.

Transportation Report: Posted online.

Stu gave a bit of history on the October 3rd, 2022 meeting of TIRRA, TIVFD, TIID, TIPC, MOTI and Emcon. First, Stu acknowledged Graeme Shelford's previous work regarding these concerns:

- Ferry parking, vehicles hanging over fog line, encroaching private property
- Safety walk on/off ferry foot traffic
- Lack of foot passenger drop off/pick up area
- CVRD wharf entrance congestion

Islands Trust was approached to advocate by bringing stakeholders together. The October 3rd meeting brought Islands Trust, TIRRA, MOTI, BC Ferries, FAC, Thetis stakeholders and Penelakut stakeholders. Thank you to Islands Trust, in particular Doug Fenton, for pulling this meeting together, and Peter Luckham for chairing. MOTI Operations Manager by Zoom but dropped off due to IT issues. MOTI Area Manager to site visit later in October. A few of the take-aways:

- BC Ferries terminal reaching end of life 6-10 years

- Full redesign being looked at
- Ferry terminal/Preedy Harbour extremely sensitive cultural area.

TIRRA is actively working with all stakeholders to improve safety, access and parking in the area.

Paul Duncan questioned the government wharf status and potential impact on parcel tax. Lynne Smith gave a brief update that we are waiting for the report from Herold Engineering but funds have been allocated and will also be included in the next budget. Paul will contact CVRD Parks and Trails for a more in-depth answer.

Ron Bannister commented that the roads were in worse condition since Emcon has taken over. Stu said that the past contractor had done work above and beyond their contract.

Finance/Solid Waste Report: Finance report posted. No Solid waste Report at this time. Refer to meeting minutes from July through September.

Ernie is confident that our finances are in good order, to meet current needs and any interim funding needs until CVRD provides our parcel tax in August 2023. There were several comments about the Solid Waste staffing and possibilities of changing hours. Marjan and Julian Jackman asked questions relating to the financials and Ernie asked that they discuss with him after the meeting.

Espokes Report: Posted online. Claire apologized for the date error which set the Island on its ear because of experimenting with different hours to send Espokes out, hoping to encourage more volunteers. Please contact Claire if you would like to job share this important island communication.

PROPOSED BYLAW AMENDMENTS

Wendy discussed the proposed Bylaw Amendments. (see TIRRA Office page)

Some editorial suggestions from the attendees: which were of a grammatical nature. (eg: at least 21 days in advance, 50%+1 better than 51%,

Questions raised by members, no motions made, documented for consideration:

- Why not enabling email voting since regular mail less reliable, many find electronic methods easier. Wendy had researched it, finding it less than ideal regarding facilitating counts and verifying eligibility.
- Difference between ordinary and special resolutions: Wendy clarified the difference between Ordinary (Regular business) and Special Resolutions (Fundamental changes to structure of the society).
- Why change current 75% to 66% majority for Special Resolutions. Done to match the BC Societies Act minimum: TIRRA bylaws require a quorum of 9 members for Special Resolutions: the 66% makes more sense from a math perspective.
- No mention in changes regarding Chair voting to break ties only, since the chair should be as unbiased as possible.
- Common practice for Chair vote as member at regular meeting but not at Executive Meetings.

The current bylaw changes recommended by the TIRRA Executive were to address urgent issues relating to notification and voting methods. There is a Special Resolution meeting on October 27th, to approve the proposed bylaw amendments. If approved this will allow us to move forward with a revote on the Solid Waste budget, which informs the type of services which will be available at the site. A further bylaw review will be done in November 2022, for consideration by members at the AGM in Spring 2023.

Wendy asked attending members to review the bylaws as posted on the TIRRA Office page and provide any concerns or suggested edits to tirra@thetisisland.net

Early communication of your input is appreciated: ie: before October 20th, 2022

SOLID WASTE BUDGET AND OPERATION

MOTION: That this house agrees to rescind the voting completed at both the April 28th, 2022 General Meeting and the July 23rd, 2022 General Meeting regarding the Solid Waste Facility due to non compliance with the BC Societies Act meeting notification requirements. John Gordon moved, Paul Duncan seconded: unanimous approval except for one abstention.

MEMBER FORUM

John Gordon moved that the Thetis Island waste yard open hours be adjusted as follows:

‘Winter’ 1 October to 31 March (following year) 10.00am - 12.00pm Wednesdays and Saturdays

‘Summer’ 1 April to 30 September 10.00am - 12.00pm Wednesdays, 9.00am – 12.00pm Saturdays.

Paul Duncan seconded. Stu Downey moved to table this motion until after the Solid Waste Facility Vote. Tricia Hunter seconded and it was unanimously approved to table the motion.

Discussion followed regarding open hours, staffing notice/hours of work, early and late users of waste site: General consensus was that the Solid Waste Management Committee should be making the decisions on these site operations.

Paul Duncan spoke of the Recreation Referendum at the upcoming election and the importance of voting “NO” since the initiative would raise property taxes significantly (\$15.33/\$100,000 property value). The survey CVRD had done shows that Gulf Islanders do not use the Vancouver Island recreational facilities.

Marjan Jackman made a request to have the October 27th, 2022 vote moved to later date and electronic meeting attendance for voting if the date could not be changed.

(Note: after the meeting, Marjan advised she was talking about the Solid Waste budget and facility operation vote: which is currently planned for November 19th. She withdrew her request to amend the date of the Oct 27th meeting for bylaw approval)

During COVID and throughout the last few years, as electronic meetings have become more popular, Wendy has received requests to move in this direction for meetings. The request is for mixed attendance, some by in person, some via electronic. This type of event was discussed, and consensus is it is not ideal, although this would result in more members attending/participating/voting. (Bylaws may have to be changed, technical support would be needed, Zoom licensing and connectivity just some of the points. Zoom was an option provided unilaterally during the declared Covid emergency, but that option no longer exists.)

Ernie Hunter stood to thank Lynne Smith for her support throughout her term as Director Area G, Saltair and Gulf Islands.

Wendy Hinsperger adjourned the meeting at 8:45PM